



Q

When we dry fruits or vegetables, what makes them last longer on the shelf?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Removing the water so germs can't grow

FUN FACT

Drying food stops tiny germs from growing by taking away their water!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

If you put food in a dehydrator, how should you spread it on the trays?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

In one thin layer so air can reach all parts

FUN FACT

Spreading food out helps it dry faster and better!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

Which food would you dry separately because its strong smell can spread to others?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Onions

FUN FACT

Onions smell strong and can make other foods taste like onions if dried together!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

What should we do with the fruit leather after drying but before rolling it up?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Peel it off the tray while warm

FUN FACT

Peeling leather while warm helps it stay soft and nice!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Where do you store dried fruit rolls for short times to keep them fresh?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

In a cool, dark, dry place or the freezer

FUN FACT

Keeping dried fruit away from light and moisture helps it last longer!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

When drying jerky, why do some people heat the meat again after drying?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

To make sure bad germs are gone

FUN FACT

Heating jerky after drying makes it safe to eat by killing germs!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

What's a yummy snack made by drying meat until it's chewy and tasty?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Jerky

FUN FACT

Jerky is dried meat that's easy to carry and good for hungry adventurers!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

If fish is going to be smoked, what do you soak it in first?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Salt water called brine

FUN FACT

Soaking fish in salty brine helps keep it fresh and tasty when smoked!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

How long should fish pieces stay in the salty brine before smoking?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

About 1 hour or so depending on size

FUN FACT

Brining times depend on the fish size so the salt can get inside just right!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What is the sticky shiny layer called that forms on fish before smoking?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Pellicle

FUN FACT

Pellicle helps smoke stick to the fish and keeps it from spoiling!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

Which one is NOT a safe way to dry jerky meat for eating at home?



ANSWER

Just drying it slowly at low temperature without cooking

FUN FACT

Jerky needs some cooking step to make sure it's safe to eat!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

Why can jerky be kept without a fridge for some time?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Because it has very little water inside

FUN FACT

Without water, germs can't grow and the jerky stays good!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

If you want your dried fruits to taste good and not be too sticky, what should you check?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Make sure no sticky spots are left when you touch them

FUN FACT

Dried fruit should feel dry and a little bendy but not sticky!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Can you dry foods with very different drying times on the same tray?



ANSWER

No, it's better to dry foods that need about the same time

FUN FACT

Foods drying together should finish at about the same time for best results!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

What does a dehydrator use to help dry your food?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Warm air blowing over the food

FUN FACT

Warm air helps take water out of the food to dry it quickly!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

Before smoking fish, why do people dry it so there's a tacky surface?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

So the smoke will stick better

FUN FACT

A sticky surface helps the yummy smoky flavor stick to fish!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What should you NOT do with dried jerky after making it safe and dry?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Leave it in open air where bugs can get it

FUN FACT

Keeping jerky sealed keeps it fresh and safe to eat longer!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

Which color of smoke is best for smoking fish and meat to keep them tasty and safe?



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Thin blue smoke

FUN FACT

Thin blue smoke tastes better and keeps food yummy without burning it!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

**If you want to dry herbs,
what should you do first?**



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Pick fresh leaves and shake off dirt

FUN FACT

Fresh clean herbs dry better and smell stronger for cooking!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

**Why do pioneer people
call dried meat 'jerky'?**



Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Because it comes from the word 'charque' used in South America

FUN FACT

The name jerky comes from a long time ago and far away in South America!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely